

ECON-1020 Introductory Macroeconomics

Course Overview

Shutao Cao

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Trent University
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Course organization

- Shutao Cao, shutaocao@trentu.ca
- Website: <https://shutaocao.github.io>
- Office hours, changed to:
 - Tuesdays 11:00PM-1:00PM, room ENW 352

How to reach course instructor

- Drop by during my office hours
- Email me at shutaocao@trentu.ca

Course format

- Lectures and in-class discussions
 - Lecture time: Mondays 5:00PM to 7:50PM
 - Classroom: OCA Room W101.2
- Given the large class size, group discussions and group projects are infeasible

- **Textbook**
 - Principles of Macroeconomics 9th Canadian Edition, by Mankiw, Kneebone, and McKenzie
- **MindTap**: online learning platform provided by textbook publisher
- Both textbook and MindTap are required
 - Recommend to buy access code for MindTap along with eTextbook

How to register MindTap

- Follow instructions in Blackboard

Assessment

Grade allocation

- Seven or best seven submitted assignments: 28% (4% each)
- Midterm test: 28%
- Two in-class quizzes: 6% (3% each)
- Final exam: 38%

Grading Policy:

1. "It is Department of Economics policy that the weighted average of the midterm test and final exam must be equal to or greater than 45% to pass this course. Students who do not meet this requirement will be given a final grade of no more than 45% in the course."
2. Extra credit: If nine assignments are submitted, two assignments receive extra credit, up to 2% for each

Assignments

- Assignments are done and submitted on MindTap
- Nine weekly assignments in total, seven or the best seven are counted towards course assessment
- Assignment is open on MindTap on each Monday, due by 8:30PM on the following Monday
- Late submission is not accepted, you can miss two assignments without being penalized

Quiz and Test

Quizzes

- Held during lecture time in classrom, each quiz has about 25 minutes
- Not announced in advance, closed-book and proctored
- No makeup quiz

Midterm test

1. When: October 27 5:00PM - 6:30PM Eastern Time
2. Where: ECON-1020 Classroom, OCA W101.2
3. Format: multiple-choice questions only, between 30 and 35 of them
4. Midterm test is closed-book and proctored

- To be scheduled by the University
- Exam is 2-hour long, closed-book, proctored
- Format: multiple-choice questions only, about 45 of them
- Topics for final exam are not cumulative, but may overlap with midterm test
 - Though, theory in later chapters builds on theory in earlier ones

Where to do what

- Access lecture slides, optional readings, review problems
- Access assignments
- Quiz, midterm test, final exam, if class goes remote
- Grades (except for final exam)
- All announcements

- Assignments
- Textbook chapters as required readings
- Practice problems
- Additional materials for self-study

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- Basic tool: market equilibrium analysis (Ch. 4)
- Measuring real GDP, inflation, and unemployment (Ch. 5, 6, 9)
- Economic growth (Ch. 7):
 - What drive the growth of aggregate output in the long run
- Investment and the financial system (Ch. 8)
- The monetary system, money growth and inflation (Ch. 10, 11)
- Open-economy macroeconomics (Ch. 12)
- Short-run fluctuations:
 - The AD-AS model (Ch. 14)
 - Monetary policy and Phillips curve (Ch. 15, 17)
 - Fiscal policy (Ch. 16)